

Autism Spectrum Disorders

ORG: B-012-HC (HC)

[Link to Codes](#)

MCG Health

Home Care

28th Edition

This MCG guideline has not yet been updated to reflect new guidance and requirements found in the 2024 Medicare Advantage and Part D Final Rule (CMS-4201-F). For Medicare Advantage beneficiaries, before referring to MCG's guidelines users should first follow all guidance related to this topic located in CMS National Coverage Determinations (NCDs), Local Coverage Determinations (LCDs), and other statutes and regulations. Content used in MCG guidelines may be used to supplement but does not replace, modify, or supersede existing Medicare regulations or applicable NCDs or LCDs.

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Clinical Indications for Admission to Home Healthcare

- Home healthcare is/was needed for appropriate care of the patient because of **ALL** of the following^[A](2):
 - The patient has had a face-to-face encounter with a physician or allowed non-physician practitioner (NPP) no more than 90 days prior to (or within 30 days after) the start of care related to the home health service needs.^[B](3)
 - The patient is Homebound or homebound waiver applies (eg, accountable care organization).(4)(5)
 - The patient's needs can be safely met with Intermittent home care.
 - The patient needs education on condition and self-management care with teach-back.(6)(7)
 - Skilled care at home is required for **1 or more** of the following(8):
 - Burden of care assessment of caregiver, with potential referral to respite care(9)
 - Coordination of care with case management program (ie, condition management, care transition)(10)(11)(12)
 - Development of individualized age-appropriate plan of care, including dietary counseling and weight checks^[C](13)(14)(15)(16)(17)
 - Developmental status assessment^[D](18)(19)(20)(21)
 - Home safety assessment(22)
 - Medication management, adherence instruction, and side effects assessment(21)(23)
 - Mental status examination
 - Nutrition and hydration management(20)(24)(25)
 - Psychosocial assessment, management, and referrals(26)(27)
 - Rehabilitation therapy or equipment coordination^{[E][F][G]}(30)(31)(32)
 - Significant chronic condition exacerbation with need for clinical intervention and monitoring(20)
 - Telehealth services establishment^{[H][I]}(34)(35)

Visit Data

Home Care Use for Condition

Home care use for condition refers to the frequency with which home care services are provided after inpatient hospitalization for this diagnosis or procedure: Rare: less than 5%; Occasional: from 5% up to 20%; Frequent: from 20% up to 40%; Very Frequent: 40% or greater.

Description	Commercial	Medicare
Home care use for this condition	Rare	Occasional

Registered Nurse Visit Goal Table

Registered nurse visits are displayed as percentiles that are based on the observed utilization of registered nurse visits for this diagnosis. Individual patients may require fewer or more visits as appropriate for their clinical status and care needs. This table is designed to allow organizations to define their goals for registered nurse utilization by choosing from the displayed range.

Commercial RN Visits					Medicare RN Visits				
10%ile	20%ile	30%ile	40%ile	50%ile	10%ile	20%ile	30%ile	40%ile	50%ile
1	1	1	1	1	1	2	2	3	3

Home Health Aide Visit Goal Table

Home health aide visits are displayed as percentiles that are based on the observed utilization of home health aide visits for this diagnosis. Individual patients may require fewer or more visits as appropriate for their clinical status and care needs. This table is designed to allow organizations to define their goals for home health aide utilization by choosing from the displayed range.

Commercial Aide Visits					Medicare Aide Visits				
10%ile	20%ile	30%ile	40%ile	50%ile	10%ile	20%ile	30%ile	40%ile	50%ile
1	3	4	5	8	4	6	10	13	18

Rehabilitation Therapy Visits Table

Rehabilitation therapy visits are displayed as percentiles that are based on the observed utilization of therapy visits for this diagnosis. Individual patients may require fewer or more visits as appropriate for their clinical status and care needs. This table is designed to allow organizations to define their goals for home healthcare rehabilitation therapy utilization by choosing from the displayed range.

Type of Visit	Commercial Visits					Medicare Visits				
	10%ile	20%ile	30%ile	40%ile	50%ile	10%ile	20%ile	30%ile	40%ile	50%ile
PT	1	2	4	7	10	1	2	3	4	4
OT	1	3	7	11	16	1	1	2	2	3
SLP	1	3	7	13	19	1	2	3	4	4

Evaluation and Treatment

General Treatment Course

Stage	Clinical Status	Interventions
1	- Clinical indications for admission met - Home care comprehensive assessment and initial home evaluation complete[JM(28)(36)] - The comprehensive assessment should be completed within 5 days after the start-of-care date. - If skilled nursing is ordered, nursing should complete start of care and confirm eligibility.	☐ Establish and implement interdisciplinary care plan; clinical goals may include QM (11): Activity tolerance/physical mobility improved

- A qualified rehabilitation therapist (ie, PT, OT, SLP) may open and case manage home care if the orders are for therapy only (if any nursing care is ordered, the case is not considered therapy only). However, Medicare benefits do not cover cases if only occupational therapy (OT) is ordered.
- Activities of Daily Living (ADL) and Instrumental Activities of Daily Living (IADL) Assessment  SR complete for evaluation of current level of functioning (eg,  Activities of Daily Living (ADL) Scoring Tool Calculator)
- Psychosocial Assessment  SR complete **QM**(37)
- Social determinants of health screening complete. See Social Determinants of Health Screening Tool  SR for more information. **QM**
- Medication reconciliation complete. See Medication Reconciliation Tool  SR for more information. **QM**
- Home safety assessment complete. See Home Safety Assessment  SR for more information.
- Hospital readmission risk factor evaluation **QM**
- Physical therapy (PT) initial home evaluation as ordered
- Occupational therapy (OT) initial home evaluation as ordered
- Speech-language pathology (SLP) initial home evaluation as ordered(20)
- Skilled healthcare needs identified

- Behavioral health status improved or stable
- Home safety improved or stable
- Knowledge deficit improved or resolved
- Medication regimen established
- Nutrition and hydration status improved or stable
- Patient care management improved or stable
- Psychosocial issues improved or resolved
- Sensory status improved or stable
- Sleep pattern improved or stable(20)
- Initiate transition of care planning. **QM**

-  Provide treatments and monitoring **QM** (36):
- Adherence improvement strategies
 - Chronic condition management(38)
 - Emergency plan management
 - Fall risk management **QM** (39)
 - Laboratory testing or monitoring, if ordered
 - Medication management **QM**
 - Nutrition management
 - Psychosocial issue and risk management **QM**
 - Report complications to treating provider, if indicated.
 - Coordinate follow-up with treating provider(s).
 - Provide patient and caregiver education, reinforcement, and teach-back. **QM** (40)
 - Review patient management techniques (eg, medication, activity, monitoring).
 - Review complications and when and to whom to report.
 - See corresponding Patient Education for Clinicians for more information.

-  Initiate referrals as indicated. (41)

- Physical therapy (PT) referral
- Occupational therapy (OT) referral
- Speech-language pathology (SLP) referral

- Social worker referral
- Home Health Aide (HHA) referral
- Behavioral health support (eg, counseling)
- Community services(42)(43)(44)
- Educational program (eg, chronic condition management, self-management)(10)(20)
- Financial, for follow-up care, medication, and transportation
- Post subacute care services (eg, outpatient center)
- Protective services or legal authorities, if indicated(45)(46)(47)
- Self-help or support group(48)
- Self-management information(49)
- Special education(20)(50)
- Tobacco use treatment, as needed **QM** (51)
- Vocational rehabilitation[K](32)(53)
- Other

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- Therapeutic response to interventions **QM**
 - Patient/caregiver able to monitor and self-manage condition, or unwilling or unable to be trained after sufficient efforts made (54)
 - Rehabilitation program established and patient participating as able with evaluation of current level of functioning (eg,  Activities of Daily Living (ADL) Scoring Tool Calculator) **QM**
 - Physical therapy (PT) progression
 - Occupational therapy (OT) progression
 - Speech-language pathology (SLP) progression

- Interdisciplinary care plan continues
- Ongoing assessment of clinical needs
- ☐ Provide treatments and monitoring **QM** :
 - Adherence improvement strategies
 - Chronic condition management
 - Emergency plan management
 - Fall risk management **QM**
 - Laboratory testing or monitoring, if ordered
 - Medication management **QM**
 - Nutrition management
 - Psychosocial issue and risk management **QM**
- Continue patient and caregiver education, reinforcement, and teach-back. **QM**
 - Assess patient management ability and techniques.
 - Provide instructional support as needed.

- Verify understanding of complications and when and to whom to report.
- Report complications to treating provider, if indicated.
- Continue transition of care planning. **QM**
- Verify follow-up with treating provider.
- Follow up on referral status, as indicated.

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- **Behavioral health status stable for patient's condition(55)**
 - **Medical status stable for patient's condition(36)**
 - **Medication regimen established and reconciliation completed QM**
 - **Patient/caregiver able to monitor and self-manage condition independently, or unwilling or unable to be trained after sufficient efforts made(54)**
 - Outpatient center care independently coordinated by patient/caregiver
 - **Patient Safe at home or appropriate referrals made QM(56)**
 - Psychosocial issues adequately addressed or appropriate referrals made **QM**
 - **Rehabilitation program completed for safe transfer to lower level of care or patient no longer demonstrating significant functional gains (eg,**
 **Activities of Daily Living (ADL) Scoring Tool Calculator)(57)**
 - **Significant chronic condition exacerbation resolved**
 - **Transition plans understood**

- **Transition of care planning completed QM**
- Discharge from home care services

Recovery Milestones are indicated in **bold**.

Extended Visits

Additional skilled visits may be: brief (1 visit), moderate (2 to 3 visits), or prolonged (more than 4 visits).

- Additional nursing visits may be needed for **1 or more** of the following:
 - ☐ Failure to meet discharge criteria (Recovery Milestones within final stage of General Treatment Course)
 - Expect brief visit extension
 - ☐ Initiate Home Safety Assessment  SR due to change in patient's ability to perform activities of daily living (ADL) or instrumental activities of daily living (IADL).(22)
 - Expect brief visit extension.
 - ☐ Ongoing education required for patient or caregiver as indicated by demonstrated ability, willingness to learn, and(7)(36):
 - Need for improved understanding of patient's medical condition, diagnosis, disease, or disability
 - Need for improved understanding of methods and means to manage aspects of medical condition
 - Need for interventions to increase adherence to therapy
 - Expect brief to moderate visit extension.
 - ☐ Significant chronic disease exacerbation, with need for skilled clinical intervention and monitoring(36)
 - Expect brief visit extension.
- ☐ Additional PT visits may be needed for **1 or more** of the following(58)(59)(60):
 - Unanticipated functional problems impacting safe completion of mobility-related ADL (MRADL)(61)
 - Evaluation and retraining on use of assistive technology or assistive device
 - Exacerbation or new comorbidities impairing functional improvement
 - Evaluation and retraining of precautions to ensure safe completion of MRADL
 - Impaired cognition that prolongs teaching
 - Evaluation and retraining of home exercise program due to environmental change
 - Uncontrolled pain impacting learning process and participation
 - Caregiver training needed with adequate understanding and return demonstration
- ☐ Additional OT visits may be needed for **1 or more** of the following(62):
 - Unanticipated functional problems impacting safe completion of ADL(61)
 - Evaluation and retraining on use of adaptive equipment, assistive technology, or assistive device
 - Exacerbation or new comorbidities impairing functional improvement
 - Evaluation and retraining on precautions to ensure safe completion of ADL
 - Impaired cognition that prolongs teaching

- Evaluation and retraining on home management program due to environmental change
 - Uncontrolled pain impacting learning process and participation
 - Caregiver training needed with adequate understanding and return demonstration
- ☐ Additional SLP therapy may be needed for **1 or more** of the following(63):
- Additional training and education for dysphagia management
 - Impairment of communication or cognition requiring new or additional interventions and education
 - Caregiver training needed with adequate understanding and return demonstration

Patient Education

- Patient and caregiver education. See:
 - Autism Spectrum Disorders, Adult: Patient Education for Clinicians [SR](#)
 - Autism Spectrum Disorders, Child or Adolescent: Patient Education for Clinicians [SR](#)

Discharge Planning

- Transition of care planning may include(36)(56):
 - ☐ Assessment and early establishment of anticipated discharge destination and plans for care, including:
 - Treatment plan development involving multiple providers
 - Premorbid functioning(64)
 - Patient and caregiver preferences and abilities
 - Psychosocial status. See Psychosocial Assessment [SR](#) for further information. **QM**
 - Social determinants of health screening. See Social Determinants of Health Screening Tool [SR](#) for further information. **QM**(65)
 - Acceptance for care for patient at next level of care, as appropriate
 - Transition of care plan complete, which may include:
 - Patient and caregiver education complete. See Teach Back Tool [SR](#) for further information.(7)
 - ☐ Medication reconciliation completion includes **QM** (66)(67):
 - Compare patient's discharge list of medications (prescribed and over-the-counter) against provider's admission or transfer orders.
 - Assess each medication for correlation to disease state or medical condition.
 - Report medication discrepancies to prescribing provider, attending physician, and primary care provider, and ensure accurate medication order is identified.
 - Provide reconciled medication list to all treating providers.
 - Confirm that patient or caregiver can acquire medication.
 - Educate patient and caregiver.
 - Provide complete medication list to patient and caregiver.
 - Importance of presenting personal medication list to all providers at each care transition, including all provider appointments
 - Reason, dosage, and timing of medication (eg, use "teach-back" techniques)(23)
 - Encourage communication between patient, caregiver, and pharmacy for obtaining prescriptions, setting up home medication delivery, and reviewing for drug-drug interactions.
 - See Medication Reconciliation Tool [SR](#) for more information.
 - ☐ Appointments planned or scheduled:
 - Primary care provider
 - Behavioral health provider(20)
 - Outpatient rehabilitation therapy (eg, PT)
 - Specialists for management of comorbidities as needed
 - Other
 - Assistance and support referrals completed
- ☐ Medical equipment and supplies coordinated (ie, delivered or delivery confirmed), as indicated:
 - ADL-supportive equipment
 - Other
- Transition plan communicated to all members of patient's care team **QM**

Quality Measures

- HEDIS Measures include(68):
 - Medication reconciliation is completed.
 - Transition of care needs are assessed and addressed.
 - Psychosocial status (eg, depression screening) is assessed and addressed.

- o Fall risk is assessed and addressed.
 - o Tobacco use is assessed and addressed.
 - o Readmission risk is assessed and addressed.
 - o Social needs screening and intervention is completed.
- Home Health Compare Quality Measures include(69):
 - o ADL status is assessed for improvement.
 - o Readmission risk is assessed and addressed.
 - o Oral medication management is assessed for improvement.
 - o Medication reconciliation and education are completed.
 - o Discharge to community is completed.
- Home Health Quality Reporting Program quality measures include(70):
 - o ADL status is assessed for improvement.
 - o Medication reconciliation and education are completed.
 - o Readmission risk is assessed and addressed.
 - o Fall risk is routinely assessed.
 - o Oral medication management is assessed for improvement.
 - o Transfer of health information to provider and patient is completed.
- The Joint Commission Home Care National Patient Safety Goals include(71):
 - o Medication reconciliation is completed. Education is provided on medication administration including the importance of bringing up-to-date medication lists to all provider visits.
 - o Fall risk is assessed and addressed.

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Footnotes

[A] **Evidence:** A retrospective cohort study of 25,357 older patients discharged from a skilled nursing facility (SNF) found that patients who received services from a Medicare-certified home health agency had decreased odds of rehospitalization or SNF readmission as well as lower mortality risk.(1) [A in Context Link 1]

[B] **National guidelines:** The Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services (CMS) indicates that a face-to-face encounter must occur no more than 90 days prior to the home health start-of-care date or within 30 days of the start of the home healthcare as related to the primary reason the patient requires home health services. Supporting documentation requirements include the allowed provider type, the date of encounter, the need for skilled services, the patient's homebound status, and that the encounter was related to the primary reason the patient requires home health services.(3) [B in Context Link 1]

[C] **Specialty society:** American Academy of Pediatrics recommends plotting the child's height, weight, and BMI percentiles to demonstrate expectations for healthy growth. Percentiles may be obtained by using clinical growth charts, such as those available through the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention at www.cdc.gov/growthcharts.(13) [C in Context Link 1]

[D] **Specialty society:** American Academy of Pediatrics recommends ongoing psychosocial surveillance with the use of standardized developmental screening tests to identify cognitive, emotional, and behavioral concerns from birth through age 5 years.(18)(19) [D in Context Link 1]

[E] **National guidelines:** The Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services indicates that a Physical therapy (PT) referral, Occupational therapy (OT) referral, or Speech-language pathology (SLP) referral may occur once the patient is admitted to home care services by skilled nursing. If no skilled nursing services are on the home health plan of care, a PT or SLP may establish eligibility. However, an OT may establish eligibility under other programs (eg, Medicaid).(28) [E in Context Link 1]

[F] **National guidelines:** According to the Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services (CMS), a maintenance therapy program helps to maintain the patient's current condition or to prevent or slow further deterioration. CMS specifies that skilled therapy services are necessary for the performance of a safe and effective maintenance program only when (a) the particular patient's special medical complications require the skills of a qualified therapist to perform a therapy service that would otherwise be considered nonskilled, or (b) the needed therapy procedures are of such complexity that the skills of a qualified therapist are required to perform the procedure.(3) [F in Context Link 1]

[G] **Evidence:** A claims-based study of 1.4 million Medicare beneficiaries discharged from an acute care hospital to a post-acute care setting, including an inpatient rehabilitation facility (IRF), a skilled nursing facility (SNF), or home care (HC), found that more hours of occupational therapy and physical therapy services were associated with greater functional improvements, and fewer hours of occupational therapy and physical therapy services were associated with a higher risk for 30-day hospital readmission across all post-acute care settings.(29) [G in Context Link 1]

[H] Telehealth may improve access to and coordination of mental health care. Patients with behavioral health diagnoses may use telehealth or telepsychiatry to access mental health support or care (eg, to get assistance with problem-solving techniques or ask about presenting symptoms or medication use).(33) [H in Context Link 1]

[I] **Evidence:** A systematic review of 16 studies involving 307 patients with a chronic disease found that remote monitoring enhanced their disease-specific knowledge base, improved their self-management skills and shared decision-making abilities, and triggered earlier clinical interventions when proper training and support were given.(34) [I in Context Link 1]

[J] **National guidelines:** The Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services uses a data collection system to establish best practices, understand costs, and identify cost-effective systems and procedures. The current data collection system for eligible patients is the Outcome and Assessment Information Set (OASIS). OASIS is an assessment tool used to identify patient problems, strengths, and preferences. The OASIS used to create an individualized care plan can be found by going to www.cms.gov and searching OASIS Data Sets.(28) [J in Context Link 1]

[K] Supported employment is an approach to vocational rehabilitation for people with serious mental illnesses. The program emphasizes helping them obtain competitive work in the community and providing the supports necessary to ensure success in the workplace.(52) [K in Context Link 1]

Definitions

Custodial care

- Custodial care is personal unskilled care to support the patient's care of activities of daily living (ADL), such as bathing, dressing, and eating.(1)

References

1. Mauk KL. Post-acute care. In: Larsen PD, editor. *Lubkin's Chronic Illness: Impact and Intervention*. 11th ed. Jones & Bartlett Learning; 2022:477-520.

Home Health Aide (HHA) referral

- Home Health Aide (HHA) referral may be considered when **ALL** of the following exist(1)(2):
 - HHA supports skilled treatment plan (ie, facilitates treatment, prevents deterioration).
 - Nonskilled service needed for hands-on personal care (eg, bathing or dressing assistance), or other service to maintain patient's health (eg, repetitive practice exercises) or facilitate treatment (eg, simple dressing changes not requiring services of licensed nurse)
 - Significant functional limitations and:
 - Patient cannot perform service themselves.
 - There is no able and willing caregiver available to support patient care needs, or there is an able and willing caregiver available, but patient will not allow services to be performed by that caregiver.
 - Absence of functional plateau

References

1. Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services. "Dependent services requirements." 42 CFR Pt. 409.45 Washington, DC 2022 Oct [accessed 2023 Oct 30] Accessed at: <https://www.ecfr.gov/>.
2. Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services. "Condition of participation: Home health aide services." 42 CFR Pt. 484.80 Washington, DC 2022 Oct [accessed 2023 Oct 30] Accessed at: <https://www.ecfr.gov/>.

Homebound

- Patients are homebound if they have functional impairments that make leaving home a considerable taxing effort or are advised by their provider not to leave home. Common homebound reasons for behavioral health patients include a psychiatric condition where the patient is unsafe to leave home unattended (eg, agitation, confusion, delusional, risk to self or others) or may be confined to home for medical issues. Homebound status for behavioral health patients may not be required if there are other circumstances considered important for home monitoring of the patient's condition (eg, the patient may need clinical evaluation of the home behavioral health management regimen).[A](1)(2)(3)(4)

References

1. Home Health Services. Chapter 7 Rev 11447 In: Medicare Benefit Policy Manual [Internet-Only Manual] [Internet] Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services. 2022 Jun Accessed at: <https://www.cms.gov/Regulations-and-Guidance/Guidance/Manuals/Internet-Only-Manuals-IOMs-Items/CMS012673>. [accessed 2023 Sep 21]
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Footnotes

- A. **National guidelines:** The Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services indicates that a considerable taxing effort generally includes the use of supportive devices such as crutches, canes, wheelchairs, and walkers; the use of special transportation; or the assistance of another person to leave home. A patient whose absences are infrequent, for short duration (eg, religious services, graduations), or necessary for healthcare (eg, dialysis, outpatient chemotherapy, medical day care) may still be considered homebound.(1)

Intermittent home care

- Intermittent home care is defined as part-time services that are provided in the home.[A](1)(2)(3)

References

1. Home Health Services. Chapter 7 Rev 11447 In: Medicare Benefit Policy Manual [Internet-Only Manual] [Internet] Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services. 2022 Jun Accessed at: <https://www.cms.gov/Regulations-and-Guidance/Guidance/Manuals/Internet-Only-Manuals-IOMs-Items/CMS012673>. [accessed 2023 Sep 21]
2. Deutsch A. Health policy. In: Larsen PD, editor. Lubkin's Chronic Illness: Impact and Intervention. 11th ed. Jones & Bartlett Learning; 2022:569-584.
3. Community-based services. In: Chies S, editor. Pratt's Long-Term Care. 5th ed. Jones & Bartlett Learning; 2022:183-218.

Footnotes

- A. **National guidelines:** The Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services defines intermittent care as services that must be less than 8 hours each day and 28 or fewer hours each week (or, for special cases, up to 35 hours each week).(1)

Occupational therapy (OT) progression

- OT progression includes **ALL** of the following(1)(2):
 - Ongoing evaluation of treatment plan with short-term and long-term goals
 - Ongoing evaluation of rehabilitation potential toward achieving goals
 - Patient demonstrates resolution of barriers to transition of care and **1 or more** of the following:
 - Measured improvements in performance of short-term goals in reasonable and predictable time frame based on treatment plan^[A](4)(5)
 - Minimal progress due to unexpected clinical event, but progress expected to resume toward goals as condition improves

References

- Bennett K. Setting rehabilitation goals. In: O'Hanlon S, Smith M, editors. Comprehensive Guide to Rehabilitation of the Older Patient. 4th ed. Elsevier; 2021:49-52.
- Pryor J, O'Reilly K, Bonser M, Garret G, McKenchnie D. Rehabilitation for the individual and family. In: Chang E, Johnson A, editors. Living With Chronic Illness and Disability. 4th ed. Chatswood NSW 2067: Elsevier; 2022:161-182.
- Yang W, Houtrow A, Cull DS, Annaswamy TM. Quality and outcome measures for medical rehabilitation. In: Cifu DX, et al., editors. Braddom's Physical Medicine and Rehabilitation. 6th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Elsevier; 2021:100-114.e2.
- Kee YYK. Measuring progress with rehabilitation. In: O'Hanlon S, Smith M, editors. Comprehensive Guide to Rehabilitation of the Older Patient. 4th ed. Elsevier; 2021:111-115.
- Barker K, Eickmeyer S. Therapeutic exercise. Medical Clinics of North America 2020;104(2):189-198. DOI: 10.1016/j.mcna.2019.10.003.

Footnotes

- A. Improvements may be measured by accuracy (percentage or number of correct trials), increased number of repetitions, decreased assistance level (maximum, moderate, or minimal assistance), decreased pain level, increased ROM/strength, increased balance scores, decreased level of cues or prompts required (in conjunction with level of assistance), or improvement in standardized functional outcome measures (eg, FIM®, WeeFIM®, Tinetti, Berg Balance Scale).(3)(4) Generally, it is expected that measured improvements should be demonstrable in targeted areas over a 1-week to 2-week period of skilled therapy. The speed of recovery is variable and may be linked to intensity of treatment, patient condition, age, comorbidities, and other factors.

Occupational therapy (OT) referral

- Occupational therapy (OT) referral may be considered when **ALL** of the following exist(1):
 - Skills of therapist required to assess functional needs and limitations, rehabilitation potential, and to develop or implement therapy plan of care(2)
 - Patient able to make measurable improvement in condition within reasonable time frame(3)
 - Need for evaluation, training, or education related to functional decline for **1 or more** of the following(4)(5):
 - Decreased independence or safety in performance of ADL or IADL. See Activities of Daily Living (ADL) and Instrumental Activities of Daily Living (IADL) Assessment for more information.
 - Mental function changes
 - Neuromusculoskeletal and movement-related functions
 - Sensory function and pain
 - Cardiovascular, integumentary, and respiratory system function

References

- American Occupational Therapy Association, Inc. Occupational Therapy Practice Framework: Domain & Process. 4th ed. AOTA Press, 2020.
- Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services. "Examples of skilled nursing and rehabilitation services." 42 CFR Pt. 409.33 Washington, DC 2023 Oct [accessed 2023 Oct 30] Accessed at: <https://www.ecfr.gov/>.
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- Home care: a unique specialty. In: Marrelli TM, St. Pierre M, editors. Handbook of Home Health Standards. 6th ed. St. Louis, MO: Elsevier Mosby; 2018:1-100.
- Barker KDD, Johnson MM. The psychiatric history and physical examination. In: Cifu DX, et al., editors. Braddom's Physical Medicine and Rehabilitation. 6th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Elsevier; 2021:1-41.e2.

Patient/caregiver able to monitor and self-manage condition, or unwilling or unable to be trained after sufficient efforts made

- National Guideline:** The Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services indicates that continued teaching and training is not reasonable if the patient and/or caregiver cannot or will not be trained in an appropriate time frame. In these situations, considerations

for an alternative level of care and referrals to community resources are appropriate to meet patient needs.(1)

References

- Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services. "Beneficiary qualifications for coverage of services." 42 CFR Pt. 409.42 Washington, DC 2022 Oct [accessed 2023 Oct 30] Accessed at: <https://www.ecfr.gov/>.

Physical therapy (PT) progression

- PT progression includes **ALL** of the following(1)(2)(3):
 - Ongoing evaluation of treatment plan with short-term and long-term goals
 - Ongoing evaluation of rehabilitation potential toward achieving goals
 - Patient demonstrates resolving of barriers to transition of care and **1 or more** of the following:
 - Measured improvements in performance of short-term goals in reasonable and predictable time frame based on treatment plan(A)(4)(5)
 - Minimal progress due to unexpected clinical event, but progress expected to resume toward goals as condition improves

References

- Malone DJ. Introduction to physical therapist management of the acute care patient. In: Malone DJ, Bishop KL, editors. Acute Care Physical Therapy. 2nd ed. Slack, Inc.; 2020:1-50.
- Bartels MN, Prince DZ. Acute medical conditions: cardiopulmonary disease, medical frailty, and renal failure. In: Cifu DX, et al., editors. Braddom's Physical Medicine and Rehabilitation. 6th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Elsevier; 2021:511-534.e5.
- Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services. "Skilled services requirements." 42 CFR Pt. 409.44 Washington, DC 2023 Oct [accessed 2023 Oct 04] Accessed at: <https://www.ecfr.gov/>.
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- Barker K, Eickmeyer S. Therapeutic exercise. Medical Clinics of North America 2020;104(2):189-198. DOI: 10.1016/j.mcna.2019.10.003.

Footnotes

- A. Improvements may be measured by accuracy (percentage or number of correct trials), increased number of repetitions, decreased assistance level (maximum, moderate, or minimal assistance), decreased pain level, increased ROM/strength, increased balance scores, decreased level of cues or prompts required (in conjunction with level of assistance), or improvement in standardized functional outcome measures (eg, FIM®, WeeFIM®, Tinetti, Berg Balance Scale).(1)(4) Generally, it is expected that measured improvements should be demonstrable in targeted areas over a 1-week to 2-week period of skilled therapy. The speed of recovery is variable and may be linked to intensity of treatment, patient condition, age, comorbidities, and other factors.

Physical therapy (PT) referral

- Physical therapy (PT) referral may be considered when **ALL** of the following exist(1):
 - Skills of therapist required to assess functional needs and limitations, rehabilitation potential, and to develop or implement therapy plan of care(2)
 - Patient able to make measurable improvement in condition within reasonable and predictable time frame(3)
 - Need for evaluation, training, or education related to functional decline for **1 or more** of the following(4):
 - Aerobic capacity and endurance
 - Ambulation or mobility
 - Balance or coordination
 - Contracture management (education, splint, positioning)
 - Decreased independence or safety in performance of ADL or IADL. See Activities of Daily Living (ADL) and Instrumental Activities of Daily Living (IADL) Assessment for more information.
 - Developmental progression (ie, pediatric developmental delay)(5)
 - Durable medical equipment (DME) or orthotic device management
 - Environmental and home barriers
 - Ergonomics and body mechanics
 - Functional mobility (eg, bed and transfer training)
 - Level of care planning (eg, home exercise program vs outpatient therapy)
 - Motor function (motor control and motor learning)
 - Muscle performance (range of motion or strength)
 - Pain or edema management
 - Self-care management
 - Wound management

References

1. Malone DJ. Introduction to physical therapist management of the acute care patient. In: Malone DJ, Bishop KL, editors. *Acute Care Physical Therapy*. 2nd ed. Slack, Inc.; 2020:1-50.
2. Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services. "Examples of skilled nursing and rehabilitation services." 42 CFR Pt. 409.33 Washington, DC 2023 Oct [accessed 2023 Oct 30] Accessed at: <https://www.ecfr.gov/>.
3. Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services. "Skilled services requirements." 42 CFR Pt. 409.44 Washington, DC 2023 Oct [accessed 2023 Oct 04] Accessed at: <https://www.ecfr.gov/>.
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5. Shapiro BK, O'Neill ME. Developmental delay and intellectual disability. In: Kliegman RM, St. Geme JW, Blum NJ, Shah SS, Tasker RC, Wilson KM, editors. *Nelson Textbook of Pediatrics*. 21st ed. Philadelphia, PA: Elsevier; 2020:283-294.e1.

Rehabilitation program completed for safe transfer to lower level of care or patient no longer demonstrating significant functional gains

- **National guideline:** Rehabilitation services are not considered skilled for the supervision of taught exercises, repetitious exercise administration (unless there is a loss of function), or are provided for assistance only.(1)

References

1. Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services. "Examples of skilled nursing and rehabilitation services." 42 CFR Pt. 409.33 Washington, DC 2023 Oct [accessed 2023 Oct 30] Accessed at: <https://www.ecfr.gov/>.

Safe at home

- Home safety may be determined by a completed Home Safety Assessment and the patient being in no imminent harm. Harm includes high risk for deterioration or injury and may include risk of harm to self or others.(1)(2)

References

1. Laplante N. Home care safety. In: Perry AG, Potter PA, Ostendorf WR, editors. *Nursing Interventions and Clinical Skills*. 7th ed. Elsevier; 2020:842-862.
2. Ekroos RA, Traveller L. Violence and abuse. In: Rector C, Stanley MJ, editors. *Community and Public Health Nursing Promoting the Public's Health*. 10th ed. Wolters Kluwer; 2022:506-536.

Skilled care

- Skilled care is that which must be performed or supervised by professional or technical personnel, be reasonable and necessary for patient's treatment, and exceed scope of Custodial care. Skilled care may be direct (eg, in-person assessment and administration of treatments) or indirect (eg, coordinating care between providers, supervising care aides).[A](1)(2)(3)(4)

References

1. Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services. "Criteria for skilled services and the need for skilled service." 42 CFR Pt. 409.32 Washington, DC 2023 Oct [accessed 2023 Oct 30] Accessed at: <https://www.ecfr.gov/>.
2. Harding MM. Professional nursing. In: Harding MM, Kwong J, Hagler D, Reinisch C, editors. *Lewis's Medical-Surgical Nursing: Assessment and Management of Clinical Problems*. 12th ed. St. Louis, MO: Mosby; 2023:1-18.
3. Medical-surgical nursing. In: Hinkle JL, Cheever KH, Overbaugh KJ, editors. *Brunner & Suddarth's Textbook of Medical-Surgical Nursing*. 15th ed. Wolters Kluwer; 2022:33-55.
4. Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services. Medicare Program Integrity Manual. Chapter 6 - Medical Review of Inpatient Hospital Claims for Part A Payment Rev. 10365 [Internet] Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services. 2020 Oct 02 Accessed at: <https://www.cms.gov/regulations-and-guidance/regulations-and-guidance>. [accessed 2023 Aug 31]

Footnotes

- A. **National guidelines:** The Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services defines skilled care as a service that is "so inherently complex that it can only be safely and effectively performed by, or under the supervision of, professional or technical personnel."(1)

Social worker referral

- Social worker (SW) referral may be considered when **1 or more** of the following exist[A](3)(4):
 - Social or emotional problems that impede medical treatment or recovery(5)
 - Abuse or neglect suspected
 - Advance care planning (eg, end-of-life care, advance directives)
 - Financial or legal assistance, transportation, or housing referrals needed

- Decision-making facilitation needed within family or among caregivers

References

1. Gandy J. Legal and ethical basis for practice. In: Fosbre CD, Varcarolis EM, Chiappetta L, editors. Varcarolis' Essentials of Psychiatric-Mental Health Nursing. 5th ed. Elsevier; 2023:60-73.
2. Barker KDD, Johnson MM. The psychiatric history and physical examination. In: Cifu DX, et al., editors. Braddom's Physical Medicine and Rehabilitation. 6th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Elsevier; 2021:1-41.e2.
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4. Harding MM. Professional nursing. In: Harding MM, Kwong J, Hagler D, Reinisch C, editors. Lewis's Medical-Surgical Nursing: Assessment and Management of Clinical Problems. 12th ed. St. Louis, MO: Mosby; 2023:1-18.
5. Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services. "Dependent services requirements." 42 CFR Pt. 409.45 Washington, DC 2022 Oct [accessed 2023 Oct 30] Accessed at: <https://www.ecfr.gov/>.

Footnotes

- A. Social worker (SW) subspecialties include medical, mental health, and substance use. The type of SW referral should include consideration of subspecialty, diagnosis of the patient, and the purpose for referral.(1)(2)

Speech-language pathology (SLP) progression

- SLP progression includes **ALL** of the following(1)(2)(3):
 - Established treatment plan with short-term and long-term goals(4)
 - Ongoing evaluation of rehabilitation potential toward achieving goals(5)
 - Patient demonstrates resolving of barriers to transition of care and **1 or more** of the following(5):
 - Measured improvements in performance of short-term goals in reasonable and predictable time frame based on treatment plan^[A](2)(6)
 - Minimal progress due to unexpected clinical event, but progress expected to resume toward goals as condition improves

References

1. Pietsch K, Lyon T, Dhillon VK. Speech language pathology rehabilitation. Medical Clinics of North America 2018;102(6):1121-1134. DOI: 10.1016/j.mcna.2018.06.010.
2. The essential ingredients of good therapy: basic skills. In: Roth FP, Worthington CK, editors. Treatment Resource Manual for Speech-Language Pathology. 6th ed. San Diego, CA: Plural Publishing, Inc; 2021:3-66.
3. Barker KDD, Johnson MM. The psychiatric history and physical examination. In: Cifu DX, et al., editors. Braddom's Physical Medicine and Rehabilitation. 6th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Elsevier; 2021:1-41.e2.
4. Bennett K. Setting rehabilitation goals. In: O'Hanlon S, Smith M, editors. Comprehensive Guide to Rehabilitation of the Older Patient. 4th ed. Elsevier; 2021:49-52.
5. Kee YYK. Measuring progress with rehabilitation. In: O'Hanlon S, Smith M, editors. Comprehensive Guide to Rehabilitation of the Older Patient. 4th ed. Elsevier; 2021:111-115.
6. Rehabilitation assessment and evaluation. In: Sivan M, editor. Oxford Handbook of Rehabilitation Medicine. 3rd ed. Oxford UK: Oxford University Press; 2019:78-87.

Footnotes

- A. Improvements may be measured by accuracy (percentage or number of correct trials), increased number of repetitions, decreased assistance level (maximum, moderate, or minimal assistance), decreased pain level, increased ROM/strength, increased balance scores, decreased level of cues or prompts required (in conjunction with level of assistance), or improvement in standardized functional outcome measures (eg, FIM®, WeeFIM®, Tinetti, Berg Balance Scale).(5)(6) Generally, it is expected that measured improvements should be demonstrable in targeted areas over a 1-week to 2-week period of skilled therapy. The speed of recovery is variable and may be linked to intensity of treatment, patient condition, age, comorbidities, and other factors.(2)(5)(6)

Speech-language pathology (SLP) referral

- Speech-language pathology (SLP) therapy referral may be considered when **ALL** of the following exist:
 - Skills of therapist required to assess functional needs and limitations, rehabilitation potential, and to develop or implement therapy plan of care(1)
 - Patient able to make measurable improvement in condition within reasonable time frame(2)
 - Patient needs evaluation, training, or education related to functional decline for **1 or more** of the following(3)(4):
 - Speech
 - Language
 - Voice

- Swallowing or chewing
- Hearing as it relates to communication(5)(6)
- Cognitive-communication
- Developmental progression (ie, pediatric developmental delay)(7)
- Augmentative/alternative communication system development, modification, training, and use(2)

References

1. Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services. "Examples of skilled nursing and rehabilitation services." 42 CFR Pt. 409.33 Washington, DC 2023 Oct [accessed 2023 Oct 30] Accessed at: <https://www.ecfr.gov/>.
2. Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services. "Skilled services requirements." 42 CFR Pt. 409.44 Washington, DC 2023 Oct [accessed 2023 Oct 04] Accessed at: <https://www.ecfr.gov/>.
3. Home care: a unique specialty. In: Marrelli TM, St. Pierre M, editors. Handbook of Home Health Standards. 6th ed. St. Louis, MO: Elsevier Mosby; 2018:1-100.
4. Communication. In: Sivan M, editor. Oxford Handbook of Rehabilitation Medicine. 3rd ed. Oxford UK: Oxford University Press; 2019:105-112.
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Telehealth services

- Telehealth services involve a remote exchange of health data between patient and provider. The data are exchanged in real time, using equipment that may send data via the internet, audio interaction, or video conferencing. The types of services delivered could include medical or rehabilitation examination, assessment, condition management, care coordination, or education.(1)(2)

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Transition of care planning completed

- Transition of care planning completed, including **ALL** of the following(1)(2):
 - Transition plan communicated to all members of patient's healthcare team
 - Summary of care, discharge list of medications, and transition plan communicated to primary care provider
 - Medication reconciliation complete
 - Education on condition management and complications to report provided to patient or caregiver[A]
 - Follow-up appointments scheduled
 - Referrals to continue medical and rehabilitation goals (eg, outpatient) arranged, if needed
 - Services (eg, equipment, environment modifications, transportation) arranged, if needed
 - Psychosocial issues addressed, or plan for management, if needed

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1. Saleeby J. Communication and collaboration. In: Perry AG, Potter PA, Ostendorf WR, editors. Nursing Interventions and Clinical Skills. 7th ed. Elsevier; 2020:9-21.
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Footnotes

- A. Health education materials should be given in patient's and caregiver's native language using trained language interpreters whenever possible.(3)

Transition plans understood

- Transition plans and education understood, including(1)(2):
 - Patient and caregiver show ability and understanding to manage condition and treatments.

- Patient and caregiver know signs and symptoms of complications, whom to contact, and how and when to seek medical intervention.

References

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Codes

ICD-10 Diagnosis: F84.0, F84.2, F84.5, F84.8, F84.9

DSM-5: F84.0

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